

Advent Wreath Reading

Week One: The Candle of Hope

READER ONE:

Today marks the beginning of the celebration of Advent, the four Sundays prior to Christmas Day. Today, we begin the lighting of the candles of the Advent wreath that serves as a reminder of Christ's coming to redeem the world by bringing light to darkness. The lighting of this wreath each week is one of the ways that we prepare for the coming of the Lord.

READER TWO:

The wreath is covered with evergreen branches that have been a symbol of everlasting life found throughout the centuries. They are arranged in a circle to reflect that God is from everlasting to everlasting, without beginning and without end.

The candles remind us of Christ and that He is the LIGHT that has come into the world. The purple candles speak of His royalty and the one pink candle symbolizes our joy in Christ. The large, white candle in the center represents the purity of Christ Himself. Each week during Advent, we will light an additional candle as we anticipate celebrating the birth of Jesus. Then, when Christmas comes, all of the candles will be lit, including the center candle, as we proclaim that Christ has come, and that He is Immanuel, God with us.

READER ONE:

The season of Advent begins with a longing. We look around our world and see brokenness, uncertainty, and places where we desperately need God to come near.

The prophet Isaiah cries out, “O that you would tear open the heavens and come down!” Advent reminds us that we are not alone in our longing. We wait for the God who hears our cries, who remembers us, and who comes to meet us.

READER TWO:

Today we light the first candle, the candle of Hope. (*Light the first candle.*) As we light this candle, we pray for the courage to wait, the faith to trust, and the hope to believe that God is still coming. Jesus is coming: Prepare the Way!

Come, Lord Jesus. Prepare our hearts for your coming.



Advent Wreath Reading

Week Two: The Candle of Peace

READER ONE:

Today is the second Sunday in Advent. Last week, we began lighting candles on the Advent wreath to help us prepare the way for the coming of Jesus. We lit the first candle (*light first candle)*, the candle of Hope that reminds us that the gift of Jesus is a Gift of Hope to our lives.

READER TWO:

Last week, we began Advent with a cry: “Come, Lord!” Today, Isaiah gives us another word from God: “Comfort, comfort my people.” God does not remain distant from our pain. God comes to speak peace to weary hearts and to make a way through the wilderness. “Prepare the way of the Lord,” Isaiah declares. “Make straight in the desert a highway for our God.”

READER ONE:

Today we light the second candle, the candle of **Peace**. (Light second candle) May this light remind us that God is making a way—even when we cannot yet see it. Come, Lord Jesus. Prepare the way of peace.



Advent Wreath Reading

Week Three: The Candle of Joy

READER ONE:

Today is the third Sunday in Advent. Two weeks ago, we began lighting the Advent wreath to prepare the way for the approaching celebration of the birth of our Lord, Jesus Christ. We lit the first two candles [light first and second candles] last week that represented the Hope and Peace that are ours as a result of Christ's coming.

READER TWO:

Advent is not only about waiting. It is about discovering what God is doing while we wait. The prophet Isaiah announces good news to the poor, freedom to the captives, comfort to those who mourn, and restoration to what has been broken. God is preparing something new. God is bringing beauty from ashes and joy where there has been sorrow.

READER ONE:

Today we light the third candle, the candle of **Joy**. (Light the third candle) The light grows brighter. And as it does, our joy grows deeper because we know that God is faithful to fulfill his promises. Come, Lord Jesus. Fill us with your joy and make us ready for your good news. Help us to prepare the way for joy.



Advent Wreath Reading

Week Four: The Candle of Love

READER ONE:

Today is the Fourth Sunday in Advent. Over the last three weeks, we lit candles on the Advent wreath to help us prepare the way for the coming of Jesus. We lit candles, [light first three candle] that celebrate the Hope, Peace, and Joy that are ours because Jesus came.

READER TWO:

The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light. In a world filled with darkness, God promises light. In a world longing for peace, God promises a child. In a world desperate for hope, God promises a Savior. Today we light the fourth candle, the candle of **Love**. (Light the fourth candle). Jesus comes to us because of the vastness of God's love. God so loved that God gave.

READER ONE:

Soon, the waiting will be over. The promise will take on flesh. The Light will come into the world. And that Light will never be overcome by darkness. Come, Lord Jesus. Let your light shine in us and through us. Help us prepare the way for your love.



Advent Wreath Reading

Christmas Eve: The Christ Candle

READER ONE:

For weeks we have waited. We have watched. We have prepared the way. We have waited in hope. We have sought peace. We have received joy. We have opened our hearts to love. And now the waiting gives way to celebration.

READER TWO:

The prophet Isaiah declares, “I will greatly rejoice in the Lord… for he has clothed me with the garments of salvation.” God has not forgotten his people. God has not abandoned his promises. God is bringing salvation, restoration, and light.

READER ONE:

All through this Advent season, we have been anticipating the time when we would light the center candle, the Christ candle, remembering that Jesus is the light of the World. This candles represents the purity of Christ Himself,

and the celebration that Christ has come indeed. We have prepares the way and now the time has come! [light center candle]

READER TWO:

The way has been prepared. The King has come. The Light is shining. Christ is born! Hope has come. Peace has come. Joy has come. Love has come. The Light of Christ shines among us. Let us continue to prepare the way—not only with our words, but with our lives.